

MARCH 16-31, 1980

small cars. For the benefit of the car users, however, the Government should induce standardisation of common accessories such as tyres and batteries so that same parts may be used in small cars produced by various manufacturers. This will bring down accessory cost due to their production in large numbers in single size and specification as far as possible. Also, other levies like road tax and parking fee should be doubled for big cars.

MADHU AGRAWAL, Delhi

That global auto makers are eyeing India's growing auto market is encouraging. However, we must also face some facts. Our roads are still the same as they were 20 years ago. Parking is a big hassle in urban centres. The scarce resource of fossil fuels is being consumed at an alarming rate. Public transport leaves much to be desired. We need to invest in public transport like buses, railways and metros. Streets have to be broadened where possible and traffic regulation needs scientific management rather than ad-hoc measures.

DBN MURTHY, Bangalore

The Stinging Singh

Amar Singh's political career goes on to show that in politics there are no permanent friends or foes ("Strategic Retreat",

January 18). He started distancing himself from the Samajwadi Party when he was convalescing in Dubai a few months ago. The fact that his 'good friend' Mulayam Singh Yadav has been leaning more towards his son has put Amar Singh in a tight spot, rubbing the latter the wrong way. No wonder then that Amar resigned from all his party posts at one go.

K.R. SRINIVASAN, Secunderabad

the pollution control boards, are likely to spell doom for our nation.

A.K. SHARMA, Chandigarh

Risen and Shining

Rahul Gandhi has done his best to put an end to the politics of sycophancy ("Rahul Gandhi: The Catalyst", January 5). About the NDA, he has very clearly said that it ignored the poor and the Left did not develop the system that is required to generate

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“A proper inquiry should help in assessing the role of politicians, mine operators and bureaucrats in illegal mining in Orissa. Those found guilty should be punished appropriately.”

V.K. TANGRI, Dehradun

Conscience Call

Your story on the state of river conservation in the country was shocking ("Streams of Filth", December 28). The 'who cares' attitude of people in general and corruption and political interference in various government departments, especially in

money. Besides Rahul, there were other newsmakers in 2009 like P. Chidambaram, Mohan Bhagwat, Madhu Koda, Chandrasekhar Rao and Sachin Tendulkar. But on the whole, it was Rahul who, through his dynamic vision and efforts, made the difference.

P.K. GUPTA, Bhatinda

Troubles of Goenka

New Delhi's political stage often resembles an endless theatre of the absurd. The players remain unchanged with only minor variations in their entrances and exits. Even the script has a predictable sameness. For those familiar with the capital's political dice game, the current controversy involving the Lt-Governor, Jagmohan, and the gutsy old lady of New Delhi's Fleet Street, Ram Nath Goenka's *Indian Express*, contained no element of surprise. The first stage of the Jagmohan-Goenka battle centred around that all-too-familiar ploy—the press conference. On March 1, barely a fortnight after his political rebirth, Jagmohan announced that an inquiry into the construction of the new building of the *Indian Express* had been set in motion "following complaints that extra space was sanctioned for the building by the Janata Government in total disregard of the master plan, zonal regulations and municipal by-laws". He listed four separate counts on which the organisation had allegedly violated building laws.

by Dilip Bobb



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